

Government Schemes One-Liner Compendium

UPSC Mains General Studies — 60+ Schemes by
Ministry, Quick Reference

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1. Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare

PM-KISAN (Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi)

Year: 2019 | **Budget:** Rs 60,000 Cr/year | **Objective:** Income support to small and marginal farmers

Features: Rs 6,000/year in three equal instalments (Rs 2,000 each) directly into bank accounts. Covers all landholding farmers regardless of land size. 11+ crore beneficiaries as of 2025. Extended to tenant farmers/landless cultivators in 2024.

PMFBY (Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana)

Year: 2016 | **Objective:** Crop insurance against natural calamities, pests, diseases

Features: Uniform premium of 2% for kharif, 1.5% for rabi foodgrains/oilseeds, 5% for commercial/horticultural crops. Premium subsidy shared 50:50 by Centre-State (90:10 for NE states). Use of technology (Crop Insurance App, drones for assessment). 5.5+ crore farmers enrolled.

PM-AASHA (Pradhan Mantri Annadata Aay Sanrakshan Abhiyan)

Year: 2018 (revamped 2024) | **Objective:** Assured MSP to farmers through three mechanisms

Features: PSS (Price Support Scheme) — CCI/NAFED procurement; PDPS (Price Deficiency Payment) — direct payment of MSP difference up to 25% of production; MPPS (Market Intervention Scheme) — for perishables up to 25% of production. Combined with e-NAM integration for better price discovery.

MIDH (Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture)

Year: 2014 (continuing) | **Objective:** Holistic growth of horticulture sector

Features: Covers fruits, vegetables, spices, flowers, coconut, mushroom, bamboo. Subsidy for planting material, greenhouses, drip irrigation, post-harvest management. Cluster development approach. India is 2nd largest producer of fruits and vegetables globally.

PKVY (Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana)

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Promote organic farming in clusters

Features: Cluster-based approach (50+ farmers forming cluster of 50 ha). Rs 50,000/ha assistance for 3 years (Rs 31,000 for inputs, Rs 19,000 for certification/marketing). PGS-India certification. 8+ lakh hectares under organic cultivation through PKVY.

PMKSY (Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana)

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Har Khet Ko Paani — improve farm irrigation and water use efficiency

Features: Three components: AIBP (Accelerated Irrigation Benefit Programme), PMKSY-Per Drop More Crop (micro-irrigation), Watershed Development Component. Per Drop More Crop provides 55% subsidy for drip/sprinkler irrigation (90% for NE). 75+ lakh hectares brought under micro-irrigation.

GS3 Strategy: When answering questions on agriculture reforms, use the "before-after" framework. Compare pre-2014 schemes (NABARD refinance, MSP procurement) with post-2014 schemes (PM-KISAN, PMFBY, PM-AASHA, e-NAM). Show how the approach shifted from subsidy-driven to income support and risk mitigation.

2. Ministry of Education

NEP 2020 (National Education Policy)

Year: 2020 | **Objective:** Transform India's education system by 2040

Features: 5+3+3+4 curricular structure (Foundational 3-8 yrs, Preparatory 8-11, Middle 11-14, Secondary 14-18). Multiple entry/exit in higher education. Academic Bank of Credits. National Research Foundation. Mother tongue medium till Grade 5. 6% GDP target for education. No rigid stream separation. Vocational education integration from Grade 6.

PM SHRI (PM Schools for Rising India)

Year: 2022 | **Budget:** Rs 27,360 Cr (2022-27) | **Objective:** Develop 14,500+ model schools as NEP 2020 exemplars

Features: Upgradation of existing KGBVs, JNVs, and government schools. Focus on experiential learning, arts integration, sports, ICT. Each school to mentor 5 neighbouring schools. Science labs, smart classrooms, vocational labs. States/UTs sign MoU for implementation.

PM-USHA (PM Uchchatar Shiksha Abhiyan) — formerly RUSA

Year: 2024 (replacing RUSA) | **Objective:** Improve quality and access in higher education

Features: Central funding to state universities and colleges. Focus on NEP implementation — multiple entry/exit, digital learning, research. Accreditation mandatory. Equity initiatives for SC/ST/OBC/women/minorities. Rs 4,000+ Cr allocation for FY 2024-25.

NIPUN Bharat (National Initiative for Proficiency in Reading with Understanding and Numeracy)

Year: 2021 | **Objective:** Universal foundational literacy and numeracy by 2026-27

Features: Targets all children up to Grade 3. Teacher training, learning

materials, assessment framework. FLN (Foundational Literacy and Numeracy) Mission under NEP 2020. National Achievement Survey for tracking progress. FLN targets integrated into NIPUN Lakshya.

DIKSHA (Digital Infrastructure for Knowledge Sharing)

Year: 2017 | **Objective:** Digital platform for teacher training and school education

Features: NCERT-developed open-source platform. E-content for all grades (QR-coded textbooks). Teacher professional development courses. State-specific content integration. 10+ crore users. Integrated with SWAYAM, NISHTHA teacher training programme.

3. Ministry of Health & Family Welfare

Ayushman Bharat — Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PMJAY)

Year: 2018 | **Budget:** Rs 7,200 Cr (2024-25) | **Objective:** Universal health coverage — Rs 5 lakh per family per year

Features: World's largest health insurance scheme. Covers 10.74 crore poor families (bottom 40% population). Cashless and paperless treatment. 1,949+ procedures covered. 30+ crore Ayushman Cards issued. Portability across India. Over 7 crore hospital admissions authorised since launch. Also covers Ayushman Arogya Mandirs (1.5 lakh HWCs).

PM-ABHIM (PM Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission)

Year: 2021 | **Budget:** Rs 64,180 Cr (2021-26) | **Objective:** Strengthen health infrastructure, especially in underserved areas

Features: New 17,788 Health & Wellness Centres (11,024 in tribal areas). Integrated Public Health Labs in all districts. Critical Care Blocks in 602+ districts. National Institution for One Health. Four new AIIMS and 15+ new medical colleges. Block Public Health Units for disease surveillance.

AMRIT (Affordable Medicines and Reliable Implants for Treatment)

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Provide affordable medicines for cancer, heart diseases, and other critical ailments

Features: HLL Lifecare-run AMRIT pharmacies at 250+ locations. Up to 50% discount on medicines. Covers cancer (chemotherapy, targeted therapy), cardiovascular drugs, implants (stents, knee implants). Price cap on stents and knee implants already reduced separately through NPPA orders.

Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Jan Aushadhi Pariyojana (PMBJP)

Year: 2008 (strengthened 2014) | **Objective:** Provide quality generic medicines at affordable prices

Features: 10,000+ Jan Aushadhi Kendras across India. Over 2,000 medicines and 300+ surgical instruments. Prices 50-90% lower than branded alternatives. Bureau of Pharma PSUs of India (BPPI) implements. Quality tested at accredited labs. Target: 25,000 Kendras by 2026. Saves Rs 30,000+ Cr annually for consumers.

Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (PMSSY)

Year: 2003 (Phases I-VI) | **Objective:** Correct regional imbalances in tertiary healthcare

Features: 22 new AIIMS established/planned. 75+ government medical colleges upgraded. Focus on underserved states (Bihar, UP, Odisha, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, NE states). AIIMS at Bathinda, Gorakhpur, Rae Bareilly, Mangalagiri, Nagpur, Bilaspur, Kalaburagi, Jammu, etc.

One-Liner Health Sector: "Ayushman Bharat covers bottom 40% with Rs 5L insurance; PM-ABHIM strengthens infrastructure; Jan Aushadhi provides generics at 50-90% discount; AMRIT targets critical diseases; PMSSY builds AIIMS in underserved regions."

4. Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment

Pre-Matric & Post-Matric Scholarships for SC/ST/OBC

Year: Ongoing (revised 2023) | **Budget:** Rs 8,000+ Cr | **Objective:** Support education of SC/ST/OBC students

Features: Pre-Matric (Class 9-10) — Rs 150-350/month + tuition fees. Post-Matric — full tuition fees + maintenance allowance (Rs 230-1,200/month depending on course). Top Class Education scheme for IITs/NITs/IIMs for SC students. Central Sector Scheme of National Overseas Scholarship for higher education abroad.

Stand-Up India

Year: 2016 | **Objective:** Promote entrepreneurship among SC/ST and women

Features: Bank loans of Rs 10 lakh to Rs 1 crore for greenfield enterprises. At least one SC/ST or woman borrower per bank branch. Composite loan (85% for project, 15% for working capital). 60% loans to women (even within SC/ST category). 2.5+ lakh borrowers financed. Credit guarantee through CGTMSE.

PM-DAKSH (PM Dakshta Aur Kushalta Sampann Hitgrahi)

Year: 2020 | **Objective:** Skill development for SC/ST/OBC/EWS communities

Features: Short-term (3-6 months) skill training with stipend. Placement linkage mandatory. Trades include IT, retail, hospitality, construction, healthcare. National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation (NSFDC) implements. Target: 5 lakh+ beneficiaries in 5 years (2020-25).

VanDhan Yojana (TRIFED)

Year: 2018 | **Objective:** Value addition and marketing of Minor Forest Produce (MFP) by tribal gatherers

Features: VanDhan Kendras — tribal community-owned processing units. Covers 50+ MFPs (tendu leaves, mahua, honey, chironji, tamarind). Minimum Support Price (MSP) for MFP through TRIFED. 3,000+ VanDhan Kendras established. Convergence with MGNREGA for raw material collection. "MSP for MFP" scheme covers 72 items.

5. Ministry of Women & Child Development

ICDS (Integrated Child Development Services)

Year: 1975 (revamped 2022) | **Objective:** Holistic development of children under 6 and pregnant/lactating mothers

Features: Anganwadi networks — 13.9 lakh centres. Six services: supplementary nutrition, immunisation, health check-up, referral, pre-school education, nutrition/health education. Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0 revamp (2022) — digitalisation, strengthened nutrition, real-time monitoring. Beneficiaries: 8+ crore children and 2+ crore pregnant/lactating mothers.

POSHAN Abhiyaan (National Nutrition Mission)

Year: 2018 (Poshan 2.0 from 2022) | **Objective:** Reduce stunting, undernutrition, anaemia, low birth weight

Features: Target: reduce stunting by 2% per annum. Convergence of ICDS, Health, Drinking Water, Sanitation. ICT platform (Poshan Tracker). Community-based events (Poshan Maah — September, Poshan Pakhwada). 10 crore+ beneficiaries tracked. Performance-based incentives to states.

BBBP (Beti Bachao Beti Padhao)

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Address declining child sex ratio and empower girls

Features: Multi-sectoral action in 405+ districts with low CSR. Collaboration with Ministry of Health (PC&PNDT Act enforcement) and Ministry of Education (girls' education). Awareness campaigns (Selfie with Daughter, Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana linked). CSR improved from 918 (2015) to 929 (2023) — marginal improvement.

PMMVY (Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana)

Year: 2017 | **Objective:** Cash incentive for pregnant and lactating women

Features: Rs 5,000 in three instalments (plus JSY benefit of Rs 1,000-1,400) = total Rs 6,000 per beneficiary for first living child. 1st instalment (early

pregnancy registration), 2nd (6 months after registration), 3rd (immunisation completion). 2+ crore beneficiaries. Maternity Benefit Programme under ICDS.

One Stop Centre (OSC) — Sakhi

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Integrated support for women affected by violence

Features: 700+ OSCs across India. 24x7 services: medical aid, police assistance, legal aid, counselling, temporary shelter. Universal helpline number 181 (Women in Distress). Case management system. Emergency Response Support System (ERSS 112) integration. Covers domestic violence, sexual assault, trafficking, dowry harassment.

6. Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change

National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)

Year: 2019 | **Objective:** Reduce PM2.5 and PM10 concentration by 40% by 2026 (over 2017 baseline)

Features: Covers 131+ non-attainment cities (cities exceeding PM10 norms). City-specific Clean Air Action Plans. PRANA portal for monitoring. 15-point action plan including PUC enforcement, dust control, biomass management, EV promotion. Budget allocation increased to Rs 1,200 Cr (2024-25). 122 cities showed PM10 reduction by 2024.

Project Tiger

Year: 1973 | **Objective:** Tiger conservation through protected areas

Features: 54 Tiger Reserves covering 78,135 sq km (2.3% of India's area). India has 3,682 tigers (2022 est.) — 75% of global tiger population. Highest tiger density in Corbett, Kaziranga, Bandipur, Nagarhole. NTCA (National Tiger Conservation Authority) monitors. Management Effectiveness Evaluation (MEE) framework. 6.7% annual growth rate in tiger population.

Mangrove Initiative for Shoreline Habitats & Tangible Incomes (MISHTI)

Year: 2023 (Budget announcement) | **Objective:** Restore and conserve mangrove ecosystems

Features: Inter-departmental convergence (Forest, Fisheries, Rural Development). Plantation/restoration of mangroves on 540 sq km over 5 years. Located in 9 coastal states (Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala, TN, AP, Odisha, WB). Community participation through MGNREGA integration. India's mangroves cover 4,992 sq km (3.3% increase from 2013).

Green Credit Programme (GCP)

Year: 2023 | **Objective:** Incentivise voluntary environmental actions through tradeable credits

Features: Administered by Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education. Activities: tree plantation, water conservation, waste management, air pollution reduction, mangrove restoration. Credits tradeable — companies can buy for CSR compliance or voluntary offsets. Tree-planted land-based credits prioritised. Pilot phase launched.

Lifestyle for Environment (LiFE) Mission

Year: 2022 | **Objective:** Promote pro-environment lifestyle through individual and community action

Features: Launched by PM Modi at COP26 Glasgow. Three phases: (i) Awareness & nudging (mission LiFE), (ii) Market creation for eco-friendly products, (iii) Mainstreaming sustainable practices. LiFE portal and app for tracking individual pledges. Pro-Planet People (P3) movement. Global promotion at UNCCD, UNFCCC forums.

7. Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs

PMAY-U (Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana — Urban)

Year: 2015 (extended to 2024) | **Objective:** Housing for all by 2024 in urban areas

Features: Four verticals: ISSR (In-situ Slum Redevelopment), CLSS (Credit-Linked Subsidy), AHP (Affordable Housing in Partnership), BLC (Beneficiary-Led Construction). Interest subsidy of 3-6.5% for EWS/LIG/MIG. 120+ lakh houses sanctioned; 85+ lakh completed. Central assistance of Rs 1-2.5 lakh per house. CLSS for MIG discontinued in 2022.

AMRUT (Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation) 2.0

Year: 2015 (AMRUT 1.0), 2021 (AMRUT 2.0) | **Objective:** Universal water supply and sewerage connections

Features: 500 cities covered. AMRUT 2.0 focuses on water security — 100% water supply coverage, 100% sewerage/ septage management. 10,000+ MLD water treatment capacity added. Jal Jeevan Mission for peri-urban areas. Pey Jal Survekshan for city ranking on water quality. Integrated Command and Control Centres for cities.

Smart Cities Mission

Year: 2015 (concluded 2023) | **Objective:** 100 smart cities with core infrastructure and ICT-based solutions

Features: Area-based development (retrofitting, redevelopment, greenfield) + Pan-city solutions (smart transport, waste management, surveillance). 7,800+ projects worth Rs 1.8 lakh crore completed. Integrated Command and Control Centres in all cities. Smart water, smart parking, smart lighting, intelligent transport systems. City-specific SPVs for implementation.

Swachh Bharat Mission — Urban (SBM-U) 2.0

Year: 2014 (SBM 1.0), 2021 (SBM 2.0) | **Objective:** Open defecation free + comprehensive solid waste management

Features: Phase 1: ODF status achieved (2020). Phase 2: ODF+ (toilet maintenance), ODF++ (faecal sludge management), Water+. Waste processing — 77% waste processed (up from 18% in 2014). Target: 100% scientific processing of municipal solid waste. 43 lakh+ individual household toilets built. Garbage-free city certification.

DAY-NULM (Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana — National Urban Livelihoods Mission)

Year: 2013 (as NULM), renamed 2016 | **Objective:** Reduce poverty and vulnerability of urban poor

Features: Four components: (i) Social mobilisation — SHGs for women, (ii) Skill training and placement, (iii) Self-employment (SEP) — subsidy and bank credit, (iv) Street vending support (SVANidhi). 40+ lakh SHGs formed. 20+ lakh skilled. PM-SVANidhi (2020) — collateral-free loan up to Rs 50,000 for street vendors.

8. Ministry of Rural Development

MGNREGA (Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act)

Year: 2005 (statutory); 2006 (operational) | **Budget:** Rs 86,000 Cr (2024-25)
| **Objective:** 100 days of wage employment per rural household per year
Features: Legal right to employment (justiciable). Within 15 days of application. 1/3 participation for women (actual ~54%). Wages linked to state-specific rates (avg Rs 250-300/day). Works: water conservation, drought proofing, land development, rural connectivity, Bharat Nirman works. 25% of district plan resources to MGNREGA works. Social audit mandatory.

DAY-NRLM (Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana — National Rural Livelihoods Mission)

Year: 2011 (as NRLM) | **Objective:** Poverty reduction through self-employment and SHG-based livelihoods
Features: Universal social mobilisation — 8+ crore rural women in 70+ lakh SHGs. Three-tier structure: SHG → Village Organisation → Block-level Cluster Association. Community Investment Fund (CIF) for livelihoods. Bank linkages — Rs 7+ lakh crore credit linked. Start-up Village Entrepreneurship Programme (SVEP). Aajeevika Grameen Express Yojana for transport.

PMAY-G (Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana — Gramin)

Year: 2016 (replacing IAY) | **Objective:** Housing for all rural poor by 2024
Features: Assistance Rs 1.20 lakh in plains, Rs 1.30 lakh in hilly/ difficult areas (increased from IAY's Rs 70,000). 90 person-days of MGNREGA wage for house construction. Toilet + LPG connection convergence (Swachh Bharat + Ujjwala). 2.5+ crore houses completed. About 5% houses in woman's name; 59% in joint ownership.

PMGSY (Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana)

Year: 2000 (PMGSY-I), 2013 (PMGSY-II), 2019 (PMGSY-III) | **Objective:** All-weather road connectivity to eligible habitations

Features: PMGSY-I: Connect all habitations of 500+ (250+ in hilly/tribal areas). PMGSY-II: Upgradation of existing rural roads. PMGSY-III: Consolidation through new connectivity and bridges. 6.5+ lakh km roads constructed. 1.5+ lakh habitations connected. Over 80% target achieved. Road maintenance allocation through state budgets.

SAGY (Sansad Adarsh Gram Yojana)

Year: 2014 | **Objective:** MPs adopt villages for holistic development (model village)

Features: MP adopts one village per year (Phase I: 2014-19, Phase II: 2019-24). Focus on: social development, economic infrastructure, environment, social harmony, capacity building. 7,000+ gram panchayats adopted. Convergent implementation of all central/state schemes. 'Adarsh Gram' status requires transparency, participation, and outcome indicators.

9. Ministry of Finance

Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)

Year: 2014 | **Objective:** Universal financial inclusion — bank account for every household

Features: Zero balance account with RuPay debit card. Overdraft of Rs 10,000. Accidental insurance of Rs 2 lakh. Life cover of Rs 30,000 (for accounts opened before 26.1.2015). 53+ crore accounts opened. DBT linkage for government transfers. World's largest financial inclusion drive. PMJDY 2.0 (2022) — focus on 'Jan Dhan se Jan Suraksha'.

Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY)

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Life insurance cover at affordable premium

Features: Rs 2 lakh life insurance cover for death from any cause. Premium Rs 436/year. Auto-debit from bank account. Age 18-50 years. Renewal annually. 15+ crore subscribers. Operated through LIC and other life insurers.

Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY)

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Accidental death and disability insurance

Features: Rs 2 lakh for accidental death or permanent total disability; Rs 1 lakh for partial permanent disability. Premium Rs 20/year. Age 18-70 years. Auto-debit. 30+ crore subscribers. Covers motor, train, and other accidents.

Atal Pension Yojana (APY)

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Guaranteed pension for unorganised sector workers

Features: Monthly pension Rs 1,000/2,000/3,000/4,000/5,000 based on contribution. Age 18-40 years. Government co-contribution 50% (up to Rs 1,000/year) for 5 years for accounts opened before 31.3.2016. Total subscribers: 6+ crore. Pension after 60 years. Central government guarantees minimum pension.

Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan (Self-Reliant India Mission)

Year: 2020 | **Objective:** Economic stimulus and self-reliance post-COVID

Features: Total package Rs 20.97 lakh crore (10% of GDP). Five pillars: Economy, Infrastructure, System, Demography, Demand. Includes: free food grains (PMGKAY), collateral-free loans for MSMEs (Rs 3 lakh crore), MGNREGA boost, liquidity for NBFCs/HFCs, PLI schemes, labour law reforms, agriculture marketing reforms (three farm laws — later repealed).

Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme

Year: 2020-21 | **Budget:** Rs 1.97 lakh crore (over 5-6 years) | **Objective:** Boost domestic manufacturing in 14 key sectors

Features: Sectors: mobile phones, pharma, auto & auto components, textiles, white goods, food products, solar PV cells, ACC batteries, specialty steel, telecom, drones, IT hardware. Incentive: 4-6% of incremental sales (varies by sector). 750+ companies approved. Expected incremental production: Rs 30+ lakh crore. Mobile exports surged to Rs 1.2 lakh crore (2024).

10. Ministry of MSME

Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY)

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Loans up to Rs 10 lakh for non-corporate, non-farm small businesses

Features: Three categories: Shishu (up to Rs 50,000), Kishor (Rs 50,000 to Rs 5 lakh), Tarun (Rs 5 lakh to Rs 10 lakh). No collateral required. 45+ crore loans sanctioned worth Rs 27+ lakh crore. 70%+ loans to women entrepreneurs. 50%+ to SC/ST/OBC categories. Interest rate capped at MCLR + 3%.

CGTMSE (Credit Guarantee Fund Trust for Micro and Small Enterprises)

Year: 2000 | **Objective:** Collateral-free credit to MSMEs through credit guarantee

Features: Guarantee coverage up to 85% for micro enterprises, 75% for MSEs. Covers loans up to Rs 5 crore (enhanced from Rs 2 crore in 2023). Guarantee fee waived for loans up to Rs 5 lakh. 60+ lakh guarantees extended worth Rs 4+ lakh crore. Annual guarantee fee: 0.75-2% decreasing per year.

NSIC (National Small Industries Corporation)

Year: 1955 (continuing) | **Objective:** Promote and support MSMEs

Features: Marketing assistance — Government e-Marketplace (GeM) onboarding. Single point registration for government procurement. Credit facilitation through tie-up with banks. MSME development and technology upgradation. Performance & Credit Rating Scheme for MSEs. Lean Manufacturing Competitiveness Scheme.

11. Ministry of Labour & Employment

PM-SYM (Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Maandhan)

Year: 2019 | **Objective:** Old-age pension for unorganised workers

Features: Monthly pension of Rs 3,000 after 60 years. Monthly contribution Rs 55-200 (based on entry age). 50% contribution by government. Age 18-40 years. Income ceiling: Rs 15,000/month. For: rag-pickers, domestic workers, rickshaw pullers, construction workers, street vendors. Enrolment through Common Service Centres.

ESIC (Employees' State Insurance Corporation)

Year: 1948 (ESIC Act) | **Objective:** Social security for workers in organised sector

Features: Cover: factories employing 10+ persons (wage ceiling Rs 21,000/month). Extended to shops, hotels, cinemas, educational institutions in phases. Benefits: medical (full family), sickness (70% wage for 91 days), maternity (100% wage for 26 weeks), disablement, dependent, funeral (Rs 15,000). ESIC hospitals/dispensaries network. 3.5+ crore insured persons.

EPFO (Employees' Provident Fund Organisation)

Year: 1952 (EPF Act) | **Objective:** Provident fund, pension and insurance for employees

Features: Applicable to establishments with 20+ employees. Employee contribution: 12% of wages (10% for certain industries). Employer contribution: 3.67% to EPF + 8.33% to EPS (Employees' Pension Scheme) + 0.5% to EDLI (Insurance). Current PF interest rate: 8.25% (FY 2023-24). 6+ crore active members. Universal Account Number (UAN) portability.

National Social Assistance Programme (NSAP)

Year: 1995 | **Objective:** Social security for BPL elderly, widows, disabled

Features: Five components: IGNOAPS (Rs 200/month for 60+ BPL), IGNWPS (Rs 300/month for 40+ BPL widow), IGNDPS (Rs 300/month for 18-80 disabled), NFBS (Rs 20,000 for natural death of 18+ BPL breadwinner), Annapurna (10 kg free food grain/month for 65+ without pension). State supplements vary.

12. Ministry of Power & Energy

SAUBHAGYA (Pradhan Mantri Sahaj Bijli Har Ghar Yojana)

Year: 2017 | **Objective:** Universal household electrification

Features: Free electricity connections to 2.5+ crore poor households. No upfront connection fee. Last-mile connectivity and connection in one go. Target achieved — 100% village electrification by April 2018; 100% household electrification by March 2021. 2.8+ crore households connected. Solar off-grid systems for inaccessible areas.

UDAY (Ujwal DISCOM Assurance Yojana)

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Financial turnaround of power distribution companies (DISCOMs)

Features: State takeover of 75% of DISCOM debt (bonds with 0-3% interest). States issued bonds of Rs 2.3 lakh crore. Targets: reduce AT&C losses to 15% by 2019; reduce gap between ACS and ARR to zero by 2021. Partial success — many DISCOMs still incurring losses but trend reversed. RDSS (Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme) 2021 — continuation with Rs 3 lakh Cr outlay.

PM-KUSUM (PM Kisan Urja Suraksha Evam Utthaan Mahabhiyan)

Year: 2019 | **Objective:** Energy security for farmers — solar pumps and grid-connected solar plants

Features: Three components: (A) 10,000 MW grid-connected solar plants on barren/fallow land; (B) 2 million standalone solar agricultural pumps; (C) 1.5 million grid-connected solar pumps. Central subsidy 30-50%. Farmers can sell surplus power to DISCOMs. 3+ lakh solar pumps installed (as of 2024). Target expanded under Budget 2024.

UJALA (Unnat Jyoti by Affordable LEDs for All)

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Promote energy efficiency through LED distribution

Features: LED bulbs distributed at Rs 10-15/bulb (market price Rs 400+). 36+ crore LEDs distributed. 4.5+ crore tube lights and 2.3+ crore fans distributed. Savings: 47,000 million kWh/year electricity; 1,900 crore Rs/year consumer savings. CO2 reduction 38 million tonnes/year. Under EESL (Energy Efficiency Services Limited).

13. Ministry of Railways, Telecom & IT

Bharatmala Pariyojana (Phase 1)

Year: 2017 | **Budget:** Rs 5.35 lakh crore | **Objective:** Highways development — 34,800 km of national highways

Features: Focus on border/coastal connectivity, economic corridors, inter-corridor routes, north-south/east-west corridors. Phase 1: 26,000 km (completed 60% by 2024). Includes: Golden Quadrilateral augmentation, Char Dham highway, Delhi-Mumbai Expressway, Amritsar-Jamnagar Expressway. Hybrid Annuity Model (HAM) for private participation.

Sagarmala Programme

Year: 2015 | **Objective:** Port-led development — modernise ports, reduce logistics cost

Features: 600+ projects worth Rs 8.5 lakh crore. Four pillars: (i) Port modernisation, (ii) Port connectivity (rail, road, coastal shipping), (iii) Port-linked industrialisation (15 Coastal Economic Zones), (iv) Coastal community development. 14 major ports + 200+ non-major ports. National Maritime Heritage Complex proposed at Lothal. Logistic cost reduced from 14% to 9% of GDP (target).

PM-WANI (PM Wi-Fi Access Network Interface)

Year: 2020 | **Objective:** Public Wi-Fi hot spots through Public Data Offices (PDOs)

Features: No licence fee for PDOs. Three-tier structure: PDO (last mile), PDOA (aggregator), App Provider (central authentication). Free registration on Saralsanchar portal. Over 2 lakh PDOs registered (target: 20 lakh). App-based authentication. Aggregator handles payments and data plans. No rental for small PDOs.

BharatNet (formerly National Optical Fibre Network)

Year: 2011 (revamped 2017, 2022) | **Budget:** Rs 1.39 lakh crore (revised 2023) | **Objective:** Broadband connectivity to all Gram Panchayats

Features: Underground OFC to 2.5 lakh GPs. Phase I: 1.5 lakh GP connected through OFC (80% done). Phase II: GP to village-level connectivity through hybrid models (OFC + radio + satellite). Last-mile connectivity through Village Level Entrepreneurs (VLEs). 2+ lakh km OFC laid. 5G-ready infrastructure.

PM GatiShakti National Master Plan

Year: 2021 | **Objective:** Integrated infrastructure planning across 16 ministries

Features: Digital platform (GIS-based) for comprehensive planning of roads, railways, ports, airports, pipelines, telecom. 200+ layers of geospatial data. Multi-modal connectivity to economic zones. Reduction of logistics cost (target: 9% of GDP by 2027). NPG (Network Planning Group) for project appraisal. PM GatiShakti has approved 200+ projects worth Rs 15+ lakh crore.

14. Quick-Reference: Year-wise Scheme Launch Timeline

Year	Schemes Launched
2000	PMGSY, CGTMSE
2005	MGNREGA
2011	BharatNet, DAY-NRLM
2014	PMJDY, SAGY, SBM (Urban & Rural)
2015	AMRUT, Smart Cities, PMAY-U, PMAY-G, PMMY, PMJJBY, PMSBY, APY, PMKSY, PKVY, UJALA, UDAY, BBBP, SBM 2.0, Sagarmala, Stand-Up India
2016	PMFBY, PM-KISAN (launched 2019 but conceived 2016) — actually 2016 saw UDAY expansion, Start-Up India
2017	PMMVY, Bharatmala, DIKSHA, SAUBHAGYA
2018	Ayushman Bharat (PMJAY), PM-AASHA, VanDhan, POSHAN Abhiyaan
2019	PM-KUSUM, PM-SYM, NCAP, PM-KISAN operationalised
2020	PM-WANI, PM-DAKSH, Atmanirbhar Bharat, PLI schemes, NEP 2020
2021	PM-ABHIM, AMRUT 2.0, SBM-U 2.0, NIPUN Bharat, PM GatiShakti
2022	PM SHRI (2022-23), PM-USHA (2024), LiFE Mission, PM-KUSUM expansion
2023	MISHTI, Green Credit Programme, PM-PVTG (Rs 15,000 Cr tribal package)

One-Liner Strategy: For every scheme in the exam, you need: (1) Year, (2) Ministry, (3) Objective (one line), (4) One key feature, (5) Beneficiary statistics. This five-point format fits perfectly in a 150-word GS2/GS3 answer. Don't memorise budget figures for every scheme — focus on the top 30 most important ones.

Answer Integration: When a question asks about government initiatives on any topic, don't just list schemes. Group them by approach. Example: "For farmer welfare, the government has taken a three-pronged approach — income support (PM-KISAN), risk mitigation (PMFBY, PM-AASHA), and resource enhancement (PMKSY, PKVY, MIDH)." This shows analytical thinking.

Common Mistake: Students often write "Rs X crore allocation" without specifying whether it's for one year or five years. Always mention the timeframe. Also, many confuse schemes across ministries — PM-KISAN is Agriculture (not Finance), PMAY-U is Housing & Urban Affairs (not Rural Development), PM-KUSUM is Power Ministry (not Agriculture). Ministry attribution is a common exam question.

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Data compiled from Union Budget documents, PIB releases, Ministry Annual Reports, and official scheme websites as of 2025.